SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & CONSULTING DEPARTMENT

Technology Comparison Matrix

Stage 07 weighted comparison of options

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Document VEL-SA-009 · Version 1.0 (draft for management approval) · 4 November 2026
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Appendix G: Technology Comparison Matrix

Method: (1) agree criteria and weights with the client **before** scoring; (2) score each option 1-5 with evidence; (3) weighted score = Σ(weight x score); (4) run sensitivity: change weights ±20% and see if the winner changes; (5) the highest score is an input to the recommendation, not the recommendation itself.

Decision to be made	
Options (min. two + baseline)	
Date, authors, reviewer	

Criterion	Weight (sum = 100)	Option A score	Option B score	Option C / baseline	Evidence / notes
Requirement fit					
Security					
Scalability					
Availability / reliability					
Maintainability and skills					
Total cost (3 years)					
Vendor lock-in (5 = low)					
Operational complexity (5 = low)					
Delivery time / risk					
Ecosystem and support					
Weighted total	**100**				

Example scoring (training)

Criterion	Weight	Modular monolith	Microservices	Low-code SaaS
Requirement fit	20	4	5	3
Total cost (3 years)	20	4	2	4
Operational complexity	15	5	1	5

Criterion	Weight	Modular monolith	Microservices	Low-code SaaS
Delivery time / risk	15	4	2	5
Scalability	10	3	5	3
Security	10	4	4	3
Vendor lock-in	10	4	3	2
Weighted total (max 500)	100	**405**	**305**	**370**

Calculation, modular monolith: 20×4 + 20×4 + 15×5 + 15×4 + 10×3 + 10×4 + 10×4 = 80+80+75+60+30+40+40 = **405**. Microservices = **305**; low-code = **370**.

REMINDER

Low-code scores close to the monolith here. If the client values speed over customisation, or lock-in weight drops, it could win. State this in the recommendation.